

From willing to help to ready to share.

Fundraiser Studio explores how timely, explainable guidance could help first-time organizers prepare a campaign with confidence.

The proposition

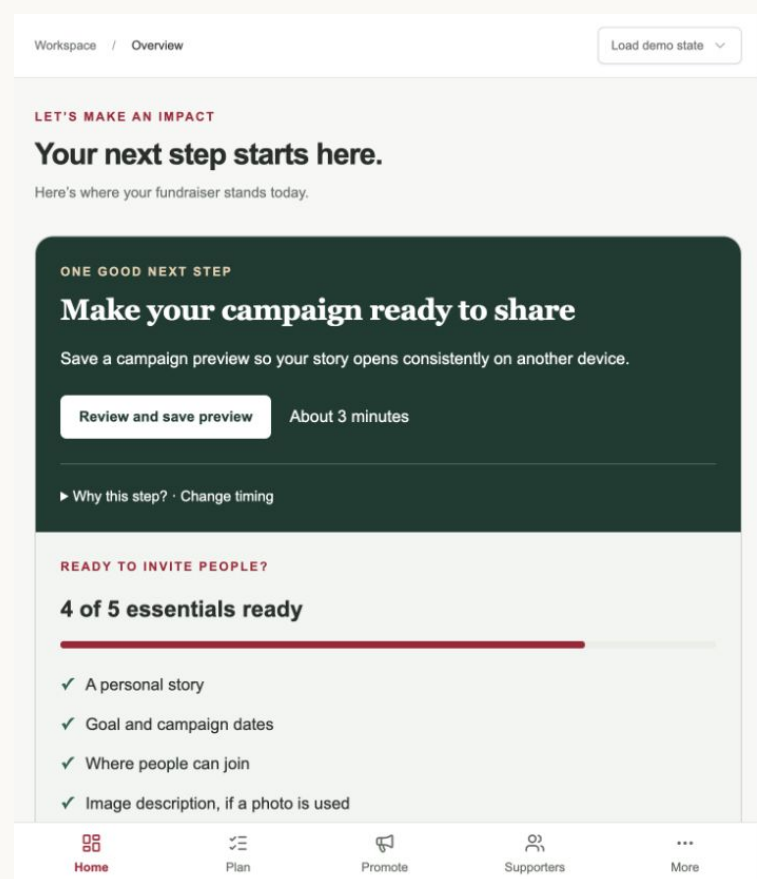
Support the moment between an intention to fundraise and a first campaign ready to share. Bring one relevant action, its reason, and the tools to complete it into the same workspace.

The contribution

Product direction by De'Andre Perry, developed with AI-assisted design, research synthesis, implementation, and verification. Working prototype and evaluation plan, October 2026.

The evidence

Implemented flows and documented technical checks. No participant sessions or measured fundraising impact yet.



Live prototype capture, October 4. Financial and supporter figures are synthetic demo data.

Complement the ecosystem. Earn the right to add more.

The opportunity is a testable improvement to organizer activation, not a claim that St. Jude lacks fundraising tools.

What already exists

St. Jude's public DIY offering includes a personal fundraising page, digital toolkit, social assets, and support. Its I Love St. Jude app describes teams, invitation links, progress, QR codes, and donation collection. [1, 2]

What remains unknown

Public materials do not reveal where first-time organizers abandon setup, which tasks require assistance, or whether existing guidance already resolves their uncertainty. This concept has not audited authenticated St. Jude workflows or internal analytics.

Where to focus

Evaluate contextual next-step guidance within the existing organizer journey. If it helps, integrate it with an approved system of record; avoid creating another account, content library, or donor database without evidence of need.

Who to learn from first

Adults organizing their first small community fundraiser with limited time. This is a recruitment hypothesis, not a research-derived segment. Experienced organizers provide a useful contrast, not a substitute for the primary audience.

Design question: How might a first-time organizer know what to do next, understand why it matters, and leave with something ready to share?

Make the evidence as legible as the interface.

A credible case study separates an observed implementation problem from a hypothesis about people.

Evidence	What it supports	What it cannot establish
Public desk review [1–3]	Existing capabilities and donation handoff context	Current user pain or gaps inside authenticated tools
Source and build records [5]	Implemented behavior and technical boundaries	Ease of use or organizational fit
Documented UI checks [5]	Specific interactions worked in tested conditions	Universal accessibility or participant success
Owner feedback during development	Priorities such as working buttons, giving frequency, editable identity	A representative research finding
Participant research	Protocol prepared; sessions not yet conducted	No quotes, satisfaction scores, or behavioral outcomes available

The riskiest assumption

Organizers stall because they cannot prioritize a next step. Alternative explanations include recruitment difficulty, event logistics, lack of time, or low confidence asking for money. A dashboard cannot resolve all of these.

Evidence that would change direction

If interviews and observed tasks show that organizers already know their next action, investigate the barrier to completing it. If existing tools solve the need well, propose a smaller content or onboarding improvement instead of a new workspace.

No constructed persona is presented as a participant. No usability percentage is presented as a donation outcome.

Design the first invitation before the full lifecycle.

The prototype explores a broad workspace. The proposed evaluation deliberately narrows to the most consequential early handoff.

Moment	Organizer’s question*	Design response
Choose	What can I realistically organize?	Short setup decisions: format, timing, team, goal
Prepare	What information must be ready?	Editable story and event details; readiness checks
Review	Will someone else understand this?	Campaign preview with explicit save state
Invite	What can I send or print?	Reuse campaign content in a promotional asset
Return	What matters next?	Explainable next action with timing controls

Keep in the first evaluation

Setup, story, location or joining instructions, saved preview, and one invitation asset. These connect intention to an observable output.

Defer until the core is useful

Supporter management, channel analytics, team permissions, and longitudinal retention. They appear in the concept but require different data, integrations, and research.

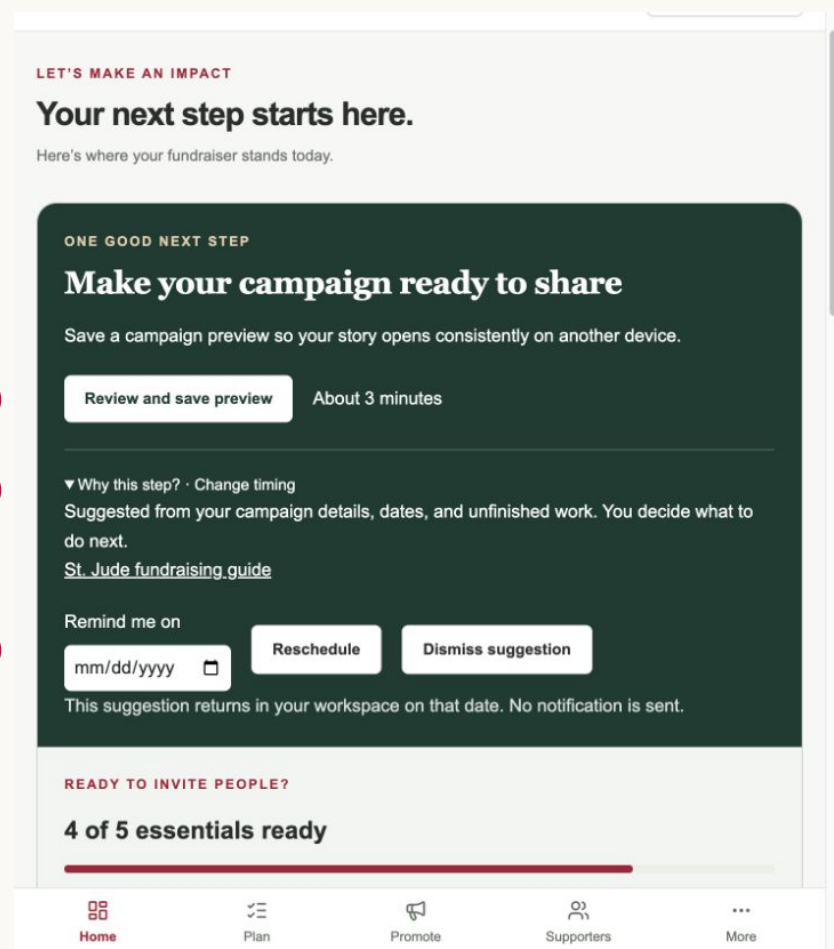
A proposed simplification to test

The implemented six-step setup collects useful context, but may delay first value. Compare it with a shorter path that gathers only essential details first, then asks for context when it changes a recommendation.

***Questions are designer-authored prompts, not participant quotes. This journey is a hypothesis map.**

One action. A visible reason. An easy way to disagree.

A recommended next step turns campaign state into a concrete task while keeping the organizer in control.



Live mobile-width capture, October 4. Explanation and timing controls expanded.

01 / Prioritize an action

Place a specific action above sample metrics. A readiness count gives orientation, while the action answers what to do now.

02 / Explain the recommendation

Deterministic rules inspect missing content, saved-preview state, dates, and unfinished work. “Why this step?” exposes the basis. The guidance is not generative AI.

03 / Preserve autonomy

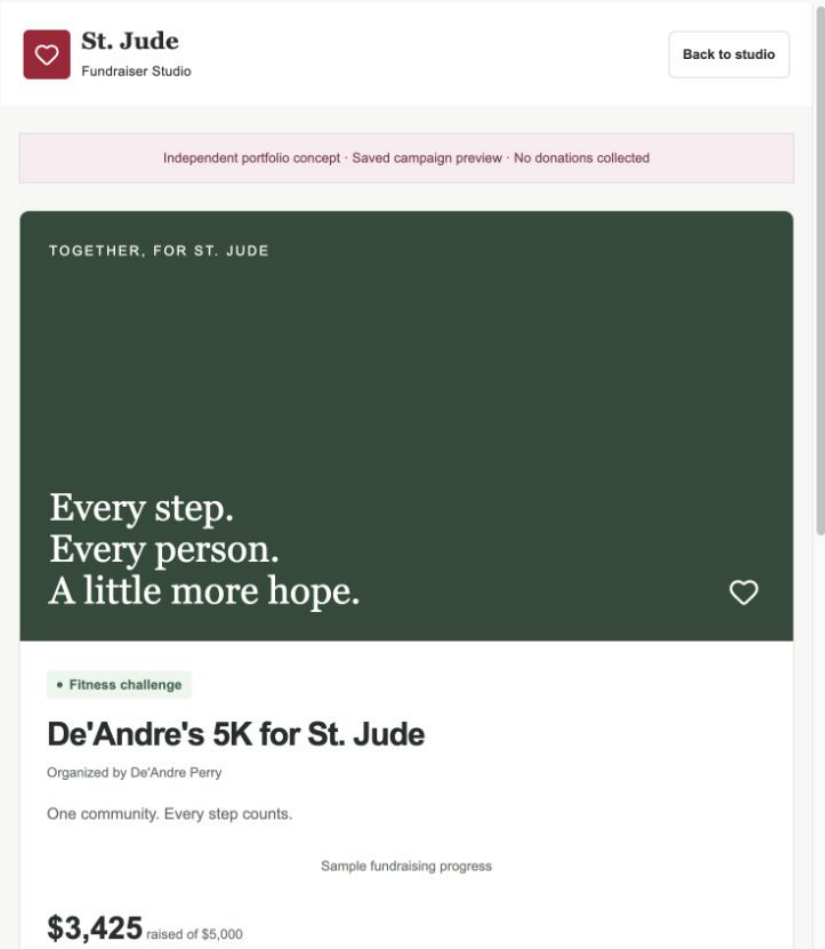
Dismiss, reschedule, or restore a suggestion. The interface states that rescheduling returns a suggestion in the workspace; it does not send a notification.

Tradeoff to test

One recommendation reduces competing calls to action, but the rule may choose the wrong priority. Ask participants to explain and challenge it. “About 3 minutes” is a design estimate, not measured completion time.

Carry the story through the handoff.

The same campaign content connects editing, a saved preview, and promotional assets.



Saved-preview capture, October 4. Active-demo amounts and supporter counts are illustrative.

The interaction contract

Editing a draft and saving a preview are distinct actions. A saved record can be opened by link within the Site’s access policy. Changes must be saved again to update that record.

The system behind the promise

Workspace drafts stay in this browser. Saved previews use D1, images use R2, and writes use platform authentication with owner checks. There is no cross-device workspace sync.

The useful constraint

Promotion inherits campaign details rather than asking organizers to re-enter them. Templates constrain visual styling while leaving personal message and event context editable.

The current boundary

The deployed Site is owner-private. A saved link is not proof of public accessibility. External participant access must be arranged and tested before recruiting to the hosted flow.

Local draft → authenticated save → stored preview → link or QR, subject to access settings. No donor or payment integration is implied.

Make giving choices clear. Make the boundary clearer.

One-time and monthly giving deserve equal clarity. The concept sends people to the official donation experience.

Give once or give monthly ×

Explore your options, then complete your gift on St. Jude's official website.
This prototype does not collect payments.

How would you like to give?

☐ **One-time**
Make a single contribution.

☒ **Monthly**
Make a recurring contribution.

Your monthly giving next step

On St. Jude's website, select **Monthly**, choose your amount, and review the details before completing your gift. Your selection here is not transferred.

This opens the general St. Jude donation page. Gifts are not linked to this demo campaign or added to its sample totals.

Continue to St. Jude (new tab)

Actual October 5 dialog capture, cropped to its boundary. Monthly is selected for demonstration.

What works today

The dialog explains both giving frequencies and links to St. Jude's general donation page. The official experience offers one-time and monthly options. [3]

What does not transfer

The selected frequency is not passed to the destination. Gifts are not attributed to the demo campaign and do not update its sample totals. The interface states those limits before the handoff.

What I would evaluate next

Can someone explain where payment happens and whether their choice carries over? The extra selection may feel redundant. Compare a simple explanatory link with this dialog before integrating an approved, campaign-aware handoff.

Success here means an informed handoff. A click is neither a completed gift nor a recurring commitment.

Working routes were not enough.

A production navigation failure changed both the implementation and the definition of verification.

Observed issue [5]	Response	Verification and limit
Published buttons appeared unresponsive; framework navigation threw a runtime error	Replaced affected internal navigation with semantic anchors; committed campaign state before redirect	Clicked onboarding and 10 workspace destinations on the production artifact; full-navigation state persisted
New campaigns could imply activity that had not happened	Fresh demo starts with zero supporters and money, and blank story/location	Empty state and next-story guidance checked October 5
Resource count wrapped incorrectly; toast covered mobile navigation	Corrected count styling and moved mobile toast above navigation	Resource search, singular count, and small viewport layouts checked
Demo identity was tied to the creator	Added editable display name, dynamic initials, and a neutral fresh-demo identity	TypeScript/build passed; the new profile interaction still needs browser verification

The transferable lesson

A route returning HTTP 200 does not prove the journey works. Verify the deployed interaction, the state carried between pages, and the destination reached after a click.

How to interpret these outcomes

These are engineering and interaction corrections based on development evidence. They are not results from participant research and do not establish increased campaign completion.

Warmth without pressure. Control without complexity.

Small interactions should support a willing organizer without confusing encouragement with fundraising impact.

A heart that stays personal

The sidebar heart toggles an optional local reaction with a brief burst. It has keyboard support, a pressed state, a 44px target, and reduced-motion behavior. There is no public popularity count and no change to donation totals.

Identity that belongs to the person

An editable demo display name makes walkthroughs reusable. A neutral fresh-demo identity avoids presenting the creator as every participant. The latest name-edit change has build coverage but still needs interaction testing.

Accessible structure before decoration

Semantic controls, labeled fields, visible focus, error focus, dialog focus return, flexible reflow, and alternatives to drag-only actions support the core journey. WCAG 2.2 informs the target; it is not a certification. [4]

What the record supports

October 3 checks recorded zero automated axe violations on 17 desktop routes after fixes and no horizontal overflow at tested widths from 320 to 1440 CSS pixels. These are historical, scoped results, not a fresh full-suite result for the latest commit. [5]

What still needs people

Complete manual screen-reader testing, native browser zoom, Safari/Firefox coverage, and sessions with disabled participants on their own setups. Assess whether guidance is understandable and emotionally appropriate, not only operable.

A zero-violation automated scan is evidence about a scanner's checks. It is not evidence that everyone can complete the task.

Test the assumption before scaling the system.

Proposed discovery and formative research. No participants have been recruited or tested for this case study.

Phase	Method	Decision it informs
1. Understand context	Five adult organizers: aim for three first-time and two experienced. Ask about a recent or planned fundraiser before showing the concept.	Is prioritization a real obstacle? What else prevents the first invitation?
2. Observe the core journey	30–40 minute moderated sessions using a neutral scenario and synthetic data. Ask participants to prepare and review a campaign, then create an invitation.	Can they finish without procedural help, and does the output match their intention?
3. Probe trust and control	Ask what a saved link exposes, why an action is suggested, what rescheduling does, and what happens after choosing monthly giving.	Are system boundaries and recommendations understood?
4. Revise and retest	Synthesize evidence by participant, task, and severity. Fix critical barriers; retest with fresh participants and relevant assistive setups.	Which changes resolve observed problems without creating new ones?

Recruit for variation, not convenience alone

Seek different levels of digital confidence and fundraiser experience. Include access needs through appropriate recruitment and accommodations; add dedicated sessions if the first sample misses a relevant interaction mode.

Protect interpretation

Record independent, assisted, or unsuccessful completion, errors, time, and post-task ease. Five sessions reveal patterns to investigate; they do not estimate population success rates or donation lift.

Research question: Does the recommendation help people act, or merely make the dashboard appear helpful?

Define what would make us change the design.

Predefined task criteria and decision rules keep the study from becoming a demonstration designed to succeed.

Task / neutral scenario	Observable criterion	Response to evidence
Prepare a community event invitation	Story and event details match the scenario; participant can inspect a saved preview without step-by-step help	Investigate any wrong destination, lost work, or inability to complete the save
Decide what to do next	Participant explains the recommendation in their own words and can choose a different timing	If two participants misunderstand the rationale, revise its wording or hierarchy before another round
Describe the giving handoff	Participant understands official-site payment, frequency reselection, and lack of demo attribution	Any material payment or privacy misunderstanding triggers immediate review
Use a relevant assistive setup	Core task is operable and understandable using the participant’s preferred tools	Any blocking accessibility issue gates the affected flow before further release

Synthesis, with traceability

For every issue, retain task context, observed behavior, expected behavior, assistance, severity, proposed change, and retest result. Keep observation separate from interpretation. Use verbatim quotes only with consent.

Consent and data handling

Participation is voluntary; recording requires separate consent. Use synthetic content, anonymous participant IDs, and a stated retention/deletion date. Do not ask for donor lists, patient stories, credentials, or payment details.

Bias to manage

The designer moderating may lead participants or defend the interface. Use a neutral script, delay explanations, record assistance consistently, and ask a second reviewer to challenge the synthesis if available.

Measure readiness first. Earn an impact claim later.

Proposed primary measure: seven-day campaign readiness. Baseline, instrumentation, and organizational agreement are still needed.

Operational definition

Numerator: unique eligible new organizers whose first campaign meets the agreed readiness criteria and has a saved preview within seven days of setup start. Denominator: all eligible new organizers starting setup, including non-completers. Use a full seven-day observation window.

Readiness is a proxy

The prototype checks story, goal/dates, joining details, image alt text when needed, and saved-preview state. The code checks saved-preview presence, not whether it matches the latest draft. A production measure needs version consistency and approved external access. It must not imply an invitation or donation.

Minimum proposed events

setup_started, campaign_saved, readiness_achieved, guidance_action_selected, and asset_export_completed. Deduplicate first qualifying events per organizer/campaign; use timestamps and minimal categorical properties. Do not log story text or donor data.

Guardrails

Monitor assistance requests, abandonment, unintended sharing, comprehension failures, and accessibility blockers. Qualitative evidence explains why a rate moves; an event count alone does not.

A later comparison

With sufficient traffic and approved instrumentation, compare existing guidance with contextual guidance using randomized assignment. Predefine eligibility, sample size from baseline and minimum meaningful effect, observation window, and guardrails. Report uncertainty and all assigned eligible organizers.

Guidance → readiness → invitations → donation opportunities. Every arrow is a hypothesis. Revenue requires approved attribution and a separate evaluation.

A tangible proposition.

An honest next milestone.

The work demonstrates a functioning direction and a way to evaluate it. Usefulness and fundraising impact remain open questions.

Delivered	Still unproven
Contextual guidance with explanation, dismissal, and rescheduling	Whether the suggested task matches organizers’ real priorities
Editable campaign, stored preview, and connected promotional templates	Whether organizers produce a clear invitation faster or with less help
Explicit official-site giving handoff and personal heart reaction	Whether the handoff is understood and the emotional tone feels appropriate
Documented production repairs and scoped accessibility checks	End-to-end usability across abilities, devices, and real campaigns

Next / Validate the narrow workflow

Arrange participant access, verify the latest profile flow, recruit, conduct sessions, and revise from observed behavior. Do not broaden the feature set to compensate for missing evidence.

Then / Review institutional fit

If useful, review content, brand, identity, privacy, campaign ownership, and donation attribution with the appropriate organization team. Map integration with existing services before proposing production architecture.

Later / Test activation

Instrument an agreed readiness outcome and compare against a real baseline. Continue only if the benefit exceeds added workflow and maintenance burden.

The case for this concept is not “more features.” It is a specific question, a working way to explore it, and clear evidence required for the next decision.

Review the work. Trace the claims.

Prepared October 5, 2026. Independent portfolio concept; not commissioned, affiliated with, or endorsed by St. Jude Children’s Research Hospital.

[1] Existing DIY fundraising support

St. Jude, “How to start a fundraiser.” Public page reviewed October 5, 2026. Establishes the existing page, toolkit, assets, and support offering; does not establish usability gaps.

[2] Existing mobile capabilities

St. Jude, “I Love St. Jude App.” Public page reviewed October 5, 2026. Establishes described team, sharing, progress, QR, and donation capabilities; no authenticated app evaluation performed.

[3] Donation destination

St. Jude, “Online Donations.” Public page reviewed October 5, 2026. Used to establish official one-time and monthly options; no payment was submitted.

[4] Accessibility reference

W3C, Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2. Normative reference for the accessibility target; not evidence of this prototype’s conformance.

[5] Implementation evidence

Project VALIDATION.md, source history through commit 1f1ecf2, and original interface captures from October 4–5. Build checks and recorded interaction checks are distinct from human usability research.

Presentation notes

Screens are actual prototype captures, cropped only where noted. They show earlier captured states, not a claim that every pixel matches the latest source. Synthetic money and supporter data are never treated as outcomes. The prototype and repository currently require authorized access.

1 / DIY fundraising

2 / I Love St. Jude app

3 / Official donation page

4 / WCAG 2.2

5 / Repository (access required)

Prototype (owner access required)